

Deal 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ T 5
 ♥ A K Q J 4 3
 ♦ J 5 3 2
 ♣ 3

14
 11 10
 5

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ A 7 6

♣ Q 5 4

N
 W E
 S

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ 9 5 2

♦ K 9

♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ 8 3

♥ T 6

♦ Q T 8 4

♣ A K J T 7

West

1 ♥

All Pass

1 ♠ by North

OPENED 1 ♠, SOUTH would be obligated to bid. But knowing that

North

1 ♠

East

South

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 1

NORTH has an opening hand, 15 points, and a 5-card ♠ suit. Unfortunately WEST beat her to

the punch by opening 1

♥

.

But NORTH should get into the bidding anyway, by Overcalling 1 ♠. This shows a good ♠ suit

and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

SOUTH has 6 points. If NORTH had actually

the Overcall will not be made with more than 16 points, SOUTH just passes.

Deal 2

East Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 5 3
♥ J 3
♦ T 8 5 3 2
♣ T 8 7

11
1 14
14

♠ Q 9 6 2
♥ T 5 2
♦ K Q 4
♣ K J 6



♠ A K J 7 4
♥ 8 7
♦ A 7 6
♣ Q 5 4

♠ T
♥ A K Q 9 6 4
♦ J 9
♣ A 9 3 2

West	North	East	South
		1♥	1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 2

SOUTH has an opening hand, 15 points and five ♠s. But EAST beat him to the punch,

so he overcalls 1♠.

NORTH has 11 points, and if SOUTH had opened she would make a Limit Raise to 3♠.

But when replying to an Overcall, the strength needs to be a little higher. In Deal 1 it was OK to

pass a 1♠ Overcall with 6 points, here it is correct to just raise to 2♠ with 11 points.

SOUTH actually has a strong Overcall so he bids 4♠.

Deal 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ A K J 9 3
 ♦ 5 4 2
 ♣ A Q T 9

9
 14 5
 12

♠ A K J 7 4

♥ 8 7

♦ 9 7 6

♣ J 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 6 2

♥ T 5 2

♦ A K

♣ K 8 6 2

♠ T 5 3
 ♥ Q 6 4
 ♦ Q J T 8 3
 ♣ 7 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 3

This time NORTH has just 10 points, nowhere near an opening hand. Still, when WEST opens

1

♥

NORTH should Overcall 1♠. This shows a good ♠ suit

and somewhere between 9 and 16 points.

West

1♥

All Pass

North

1♠

East

Pass

South

3♠

SOUTH has 13 points. If NORTH had actually OPENED 1♠, SOUTH would insist on game. But NORTH didn't

3♠ by North

Open, she just Overcalled. So SOUTH must be more cautious. He jumps to 3♠ and NORTH shows her

minimum type hand by passing.

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 7 4
 ♥ A K 9 8 3 2
 ♦ 4
 ♣ J 9

15
 11 4
 10

♠ K 9 8 6

♥ 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K Q 7 5



♠ A T 5 3

♥ T 7 5

♦ Q 8

♣ A 8 6 2

♠ 2

♥ Q J 6

♦ J T 9 6 5 2

♣ T 4 3

West

1 ♥

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

North

Dbl

4 ♠

East

Pass

South

2 ♠

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 4

NORTH has 15 points, a singleton in the opponent's suit and 4-card support for any suit

partner might name. In other words, a perfect Takeout Double.

SOUTH needs to make a medium-strong bid to apprise NORTH of her 10 points. She jumps to 2 ♠.

NORTH's hand is now worth 17 points because of the singleton. Since he is quite happy with

♠s he bids 4 ♠.

Deal 5

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9
 ♥ K 8 5
 ♦ A T 9 7 5
 ♣ Q T 3

1
 12 13
 14

♠ 7 6 4 2

♥ 7 6 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 9 8



♠ 5 3

♥ A J 4 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K 7 4 2

♠ A Q J T 8

♥ Q T 9

♦ 3 2

♣ A 6 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

All Pass

2♣ by North

1♠

Dbl

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 5

SOUTH has 14 points, a doubleton in the opponent's ♠ suit and at least three cards in

each of the other suits. This is a normal Takeout Double.

NORTH has a really awful hand. He has just one point and his only 4-card suit is the one the

opponents have already bid. He wants nothing more than to pass.

But he cannot pass. Partner's Double said "Bid your best suit.", so he bids 2♣.

Mercifully SOUTH also passes.

Deal 6

West Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K 6 2
♥ A 8 4
♦ 6 4 2
♣ K Q 9 7

14
12 1
13

♠ Q 9 8 5
♥ K Q T 5
♦ A K 3
♣ 4 2



♠ A J T 7
♥ J 7
♦ Q J 9 5
♣ A 8 3

♠ 4 3
♥ 9 6 3 2
♦ T 8 7
♣ J T 6 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Dbl	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			



s so she suggests ♠s.

NORTH agrees with ♠s and bids game, 4 ♠.

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 6

With 14 points, ♣ shortage, and support for the other suits NORTH makes a Takeout Double.

SOUTH has 13 points so she bids 2 ♣. This is an artificial bid, apprising NORTH of SOUTH's opening

hand strength, and forcing the partnership to reach the game level.

NORTH suggests



s as trumps.

SOUTH doesn't like

Deal 7

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ T 6 2
 ♥ A T
 ♦ T 9 8 4 2
 ♣ T 9 2

16
 4 12
 8

♠ A K J 9 8 3

♥ 7

♦ A K J 3

♣ 7 5



♠ Q 7 4

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ Q 5

♣ A 8 6 3

♠ 5

♥ K Q J 8 4 3

♦ 7 6

♣ K Q J 4

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
Pass	Dbl	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			

SOUTH raises to 4♠.

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 7

EAST's 1



opening is passed around to NORTH. He is

tempted to overcall 1♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall.

Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points SOUTH is not strong enough to jump. She bids 2♣.

NORTH now bids 2♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit,

he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

Deal 8

East Deals
None Vul

♠ T 6 3
♥ T 5 3 2
♦ T 3
♣ T 7 4 2

11
0 11
18

♠ 8 7
♥ A 9 7 6
♦ A 6 2
♣ K 9 6 3



♠ A J 9
♥ K Q 8
♦ Q 7 4
♣ A Q 8 5

♠ K Q 5 4 2
♥ J 4
♦ K J 9 8 5
♣ J

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	1NT
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 8

SOUTH has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT.

For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

NORTH bids 2 ♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When SOUTH denies holding

a 4-card Major NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper

since SOUTH promised he had the suit controlled.

Deal 9

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 4
 ♥ A 9 3
 ♦ K Q 5 4 3 2
 ♣ A T 7

20
 13 5
 2

♠ A 8 6
 ♥ K Q J
 ♦ A J 9 7
 ♣ K Q 4



♠ J T 5 2
 ♥ 7 6 4 2
 ♦ 8 6
 ♣ J 8 6

♠ K Q 9 7 3
 ♥ T 8 5
 ♦ T
 ♣ 9 5 3 2

West

1 ♦

Pass

All Pass

1NT by North

North

Dbl

1NT

East

Pass

South

1 ♠

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 9

NORTH has 20 points, excellent



stoppers and a balanced hand.

She is two points too strong to overcall 1NT.
Instead, she doubles.

SOUTH has an awful hand - but since he is
forced to bid he says 1 ♠, assuming NORTH
wants

to hear his best suit.

NORTH now bids 1NT, showing the balanced
19-21 point hand. SOUTH passes, of course.

Deal 10

East Deals
None Vul

♠ T 9 8 5
♥ 9 4
♦ T 9 6 2
♣ 5 3 2

10
0 11
19

♠ K J 6 2
♥ 6 5
♦ A Q 3
♣ 9 8 7 4



♠ Q 7 4
♥ A Q T
♦ K J 7 5
♣ A K 6

♠ A 3
♥ K J 8 7 3 2
♦ 8 4
♣ Q J T

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Dbl
Pass	2♠	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 10

SOUTH has a 19 point balanced hand, including a stop in



s.

He plans to double, then bid NT. (see Deal 9)

NORTH has 10 points though, so he jumps to 2♠.

In theory SOUTH could now bid 2NT to continue the description of his hand, but he might as well

go ahead and bid 3NT instead.

Deal 11

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -
 ♥ K Q T 7 3
 ♦ A 9 8 7 5
 ♣ Q 5 3

12
 11 4
 13

♠ A Q T 5 3

♥ 6 4

♦ Q T

♣ A 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 4 2

♥ A 8 5

♦ K J 3 2

♣ J 2

♠ 9 8 7 6

♥ J 9 2

♦ 6 4

♣ K T 8 6

West

1 ♥

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

North

1 ♠

4 ♠

East

Pass

South

3 ♠

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 11

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 13 points NORTH should overcall 1 ♠.

SOUTH has 13 points and four ♠s. If NORTH had opened, SOUTH's hand would be good enough

to insist on game. But since NORTH overcalled, SOUTH merely invites with a jump to 3 ♠.

NORTH has better than a minimum overcall so she accepts the invitation and bids 4 ♠.

Deal 12

West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 8 2
♥ A 3
♦ K J T 4
♣ Q 8 6 4

13
14 2
11

♠ K J 6 4
♥ J T 7 5
♦ 6
♣ A K J 3



♠ Q 3
♥ K Q 9 8 6 4
♦ A 5 2
♣ 9 5

♠ T 9 7 5
♥ 2
♦ Q 9 8 7 3
♣ T 7 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			

NORTH passes happily.

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 12

NORTH has a very minimum Takeout Double of 1

♦

. But what it lacks

in strength, it makes up for with perfect distribution.

SOUTH has 13 points and only wants to play in one contract, 4

♥

.

Deal 13

East Deals
Both Vul

♠ Q 8 3 2
♥ 9 8 6 3
♦ T 2
♣ 9 8 5

9
2 11
18

♠ J 7 6
♥ T 5 2
♦ A J 9 4
♣ K T 2



♠ A T 9 4
♥ K Q J 7
♦ Q 6
♣ A Q 4

♠ K 5
♥ A 4
♦ K 8 7 5 3
♣ J 7 6 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Dbl
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			



s are covered,

so she bids 3NT.

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 13

SOUTH has 18 points, a doubleton in the opponent's suit, and at least three cards in the unbid suits.

This is an ideal hand for a Takeout Double.

NORTH has good strength in EAST's



suit, probably two stoppers.

He has 9 points and no 4-card suit of his own.
This is the type of hand to respond 1NT.

SOUTH is happy to play Notrump now that she knows the

Deal 14

West Deals
None Vul

♠ J T
♥ K T 7 6 3
♦ Q 9 8 5
♣ A K

13
13 0
14

♠ A K 9 6 4
♥ Q 5
♦ K 7 4
♣ J T 7



♠ Q 8
♥ A J 9 2
♦ A J 6
♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ 7 5 3 2
♥ 8 4
♦ T 3 2
♣ 6 5 4 2

West
1 ♥
Pass
All Pass

North
1 ♠
3NT

East
Pass

South
2NT

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 14

NORTH has an opening hand, 14 points and five ♠s. But WEST beat him to the punch,

so he overcalls 1 ♠.

SOUTH also has 14 points, she doesn't care too much for ♠s, but she has an

excellent stopper in



s.

She jumps to 2NT, inviting NORTH to bid game.

3NT by South

Since NORTH has several points more than he might have had, and no 6-card ♠ suit to rebid,

he happily bids 3NT.

Deal 15

West Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q J 6 4 2
♥ A 4 2
♦ J
♣ T 9 5

15
11 0
14

♠ 8 7
♥ K Q 9 7
♦ A K 8 3
♣ Q J 4



♠ A 9 3
♥ J T 5 3
♦ Q 5
♣ A K 8 6

♠ T 5
♥ 8 6
♦ T 9 7 6 4 2
♣ 7 3 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Dbl	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

♥

.

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 15

NORTH has 15 points and all the requirements for a Takeout Double of 1 ♠.

With 14 points of his own, SOUTH knows his side needs to be in a game somewhere. He passes this information

to NORTH with a cue-bid of 2 ♠.

NORTH gets the message and starts the hunt for a trump fit by bidding 3

♥

. That

makes it easy for SOUTH - he bids 4

Deal 16

East Deals
None Vul

♠ T 8
♥ T 4 3
♦ A 8 6
♣ J T 5 4 3

8
5 11
16

♠ K 7 5
♥ 8 5 2
♦ K Q 3
♣ 9 7 6 2



♠ A Q J 6 4 2
♥ A 7
♦ J 7 2
♣ A 8

♠ 9 3
♥ K Q J 9 6
♦ T 9 5 4
♣ K Q

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Dbl
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 16

There is only one reason that SOUTH should not overcall with 1♠. He is too strong.

The maximum strength of an overcall is 16 points. Above that you should double.

So SOUTH doubles, and after NORTH bids 2♣, SOUTH bids 2♠. This shows an overcall

type hand, but with 17 or more points.

NORTH has fine trump support and 8 points so she bids a confident 4♠.

Deal 17

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6 4
 ♥ Q 8
 ♦ A J T 8 3 2
 ♣ T 4

13
 11 1
 15

♠ K 9 8 3
 ♥ 7 6
 ♦ K Q 5
 ♣ A J 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 2
 ♥ A K 4 3
 ♦ 7 4
 ♣ K Q 8 2

♠ T 7 5
 ♥ J T 9 5 2
 ♦ 9 6
 ♣ 9 5 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 17

NORTH has 13 points but has no bid over 1

♦

.

SOUTH can make a Takeout Double, so he does.

NORTH now cue-bids

♦

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

to show opening hand strength.

SOUTH shows his

♥

3NT by North
 suit, NORTH doesn't like it.

NORTH shows her ♠ suit, SOUTH doesn't like it.

SOUTH shows his ♣ suit, NORTH likes it fine, but decides 3NT will be easier than 5 ♣.

Deal 18

South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A J T 7 4
♥ A 7 3
♦ A 8 6
♣ 9 5

8
13 6
13

♠ 8
♥ K J T 9 4
♦ T 9
♣ A 8 7 4 3



♠ K Q 5 3 2
♥ 8 2
♦ K Q 3 2
♣ Q J

♠ 9 6
♥ Q 6 5
♦ J 7 5 4
♣ K T 6 2

West

North

East

South
1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by South

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 18

WEST would have had a great opening 1 ♠ bid. But when SOUTH opened 1 ♠

in front of him he was hornswaggled. He couldn't bid any other suit, he couldn't bid 1NT

and he sure couldn't bid ♠s. So he must pass.

And so does everybody else pass.

Deal 19

West Deals
None Vul

♠ 6 4
♥ K Q 9 6
♦ A 4
♣ A Q 9 8 4

8
15 9
8

♠ K Q J 9 7 5 3
♥ 7 4
♦ Q 3
♣ 6 2



♠ A 8 2
♥ J 5 2
♦ K 9 8 6
♣ 7 5 3

♠ T
♥ A T 8 3
♦ J T 7 5 2
♣ K J T

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	3 ♠		
All Pass			
3 ♠ by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 19

If West had passed, NORTH would have opened with a preemptive 3 ♠.

She should make the same bid with the same hand AFTER the opponents open. And she makes it

for the same reason, to describe her hand and to take away bidding space from the opponents.

SOUTH treats it just like a Preemptive 3-bid, even though it is now called a Weak Jump Overcall.

In this case, SOUTH passes.

Deal 20

East Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 9 6 3
♥ K T 7 2
♦ 9 2
♣ Q 7 2

6
7 17
10

♠ K 7 2
♥ Q J 5 4
♦ 6 3
♣ 9 8 6 4



♠ A J T 8 5
♥ 6 3
♦ A J T 8 5
♣ 3

♠ 4
♥ A 9 8
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ A K J T 5

West

North

East
1 ♣

South
1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by South

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 20

SOUTH has 12 points, but with two 5-card suits worthy of an overcall. There isn't really a

right and wrong here, but it usually works out best to overcall in the higher-ranking suit. That

leaves open the possibility of bidding the second suit later.

In this Deal, after SOUTH overcalls 1 ♠, that later possibility never happens because

everybody should pass.

Deal 21

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q 8 6
♥ Q 8 6 3
♦ 9 8 4 3
♣ 8 5

17
4 12
7

♠ K J T 7 4 2

♥ A 9

♦ T 6

♣ A K Q



♠ 9

♥ K J T 7 5

♦ Q J 7 5

♣ T 9 3

♠ A 5 3

♥ 4 2

♦ A K 2

♣ J 7 6 4 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by North

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 21

EAST has 13 points but she has to pass.

She cannot Double without support for



s.

She cannot bid 1NT without 2 more points.

She cannot overcall 2♣ with a terrible suit like that.

And WEST of course must also pass.

Deal 22

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q J 8 4 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q 8 7

♣ 8 3

4

10 14

12

♠ -

♥ T 9 4 3

♦ 6 4 3 2

♣ K J T 9 4



♠ A 9 7 6 5

♥ A 8 5

♦ A T 9

♣ 6 5

♠ T 3

♥ K J 7 6

♦ K J 5

♣ A Q 7 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

Pass

Dbl

All Pass

1 ♠ by South

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 22

WEST obviously has to pass when SOUTH opens 1 ♠.

EAST has a reasonable Takeout Double. She hopes WEST will name a suit and they can just

play a partscore.

You should almost always bid when partner makes a Takeout Double. Almost always. This is the one time

when you don't. WEST's ♠ are so good that he passes, converting the Takeout Double into a

Penalty Double.

Deal 23

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4 3
♥ T 6 5
♦ Q 4 2
♣ A K Q 7

11
11 2
16

♠ A K 8 7 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ K 7 6

♣ 6 5



♠ Q J 5

♥ A K Q 2

♦ A 9 8 5

♣ 4 2

♠ T 6

♥ 7 4 3

♦ J T 3

♣ J T 9 8 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 23

NORTH has a normal overcall of 1 ♠.

SOUTH has a really good hand, but he doesn't have to worry about missing a slam since NORTH will

not have more than 16 points. So he just bids what he thinks NORTH can make, 4 ♠.

West

1 ♣

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

North

1 ♠

East

Pass

South

4 ♠

Deal 24

West Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 7 2
♥ T 9
♦ A Q 7 2
♣ 7 3 2

11
11 9
9

♠ K Q 3
♥ K Q J 5 3
♦ 9 6 5
♣ T 6



♠ T 6 5
♥ 8 4
♦ K J T 3
♣ A J 8 4

♠ 9 8 4
♥ A 7 6 2
♦ 8 4
♣ K Q 9 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	1 ♥	Pass	1NT
All Pass			
1NT by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set10 24

NORTH has 12 points and a good enough suit to overcall 1

♥

.

SOUTH has 9 points with a good

♦

stopper. She bids 1NT.

NORTH has nothing more to say, and lets SOUTH play 1NT.